FilsPay Submission Guidelines

These guidelines explain what your team needs to submit, how to structure your submission document and how to prepare your pitch.

Everything is due by Friday at 11 pm. Nothing can be changed after that, including your code, server, documents and slides.

The submission link will be shared with you later. Use it to submit everything listed in section 1.

Important: submit your own public fork. Fork the challenge repository to your own GitHub account and make sure the fork is public. Move all of your code into that fork before 11 pm. The repository link you submit must point to your public fork, not to the original challenge repository. We can only judge code that is in your public fork.

Worked on a local copy instead of a fork? Don't worry. Section 5 at the end of these guidelines shows you how to move your work across.

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1. What to submit

Submit these four things by Friday at 11 pm.

#	Item	Format	Details
1	Submission document	One PDF named TeamName_FilsPay_Submission.pdf	Holds everything we ask for, in the structure in section 2.
2	Slide deck	One PDF named TeamName_FilsPay_Slides.pdf	Your pitch for the final, if your team qualifies. See section 3 for a recommended structure.
3	Repository link	One link to your own public fork of the challenge repository	We judge the last version saved to your fork before 11 pm. You can clone and make as many copies as you like while you work, but all of your code must end up in your public fork, and you submit a link to only that one. It must include your AI setup files: agent instructions, custom commands, tool configuration, permission rules and helper scripts.
4	Live deployment	Your running server	Must stay reachable until judging ends. Put the URLs on the cover page of your submission document.

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2. Submission document structure

Please use these sections, in this order and with these headings, so every judge finds the same thing in the same place.

Cover page

- Team name, team members and what each person owned
- Live URLs for checkout, the merchant dashboard, the admin console and the public API
- Link to your public fork, and the ID of your last commit before the deadline (GitHub shows it next to each commit)

1. Summary

- Half a page: what you found, what you fixed, what you left alone, and the main root cause

2. Architecture and deployment

- A diagram showing every service and port, and which ones face the internet
- The one command (or infrastructure as code) to redeploy
- Where secrets come from
- Health checks, restart policies, and how a redeploy avoids interrupting a settlement run

3. Capacity

- Your estimate of how many simulated users you can serve on the fixed scenario
- Your own load test: tool, method and results
- Where the bottleneck is
- How your stack turns away excess load and recovers

4. Findings report

- **Findings:** one entry per finding, with the symptom, how you found and reproduced it, the root cause, the fix, how you verified it (test, query or reproduction) and the effect on existing data
- **Root causes:** group findings that share an underlying cause and explain the design decision behind them
- **Decisions and open risks:** anything you chose not to change or run, why, the safeguard you'd propose, and what is still unresolved

5. UI and UX changes

- Each change: what it is, why it mattered, and before and after screenshots. Link any recording.

6. AI usage

- **Setup:** what you built and where it lives in the repository
- **Three annotated transcript excerpts.** For each one: the finding it supports, your prompt and what context or tools the AI had, the relevant part of the AI's answer, how you verified it and what that showed, and what you changed. At least one excerpt should show the AI being wrong and how you noticed.

Appendix (optional)

- Extra evidence such as queries, test output, logs and load test graphs

3. Semi-final and final

Semi-final. Each team is directed to one of the five judging rooms and has **15 minutes** with its judge:

- Before your session, the judge receives the results of the automated tests we run on your website.
- For the first **2 to 3 minutes**, explain your key findings verbally and briefly show the judge your website.
- The judge spends the rest of the time evaluating your work against the judging criteria.

Final. If your team qualifies, you have **4 minutes** to pitch, followed by **7 minutes of questions**. No extra time will be given. Prepare your pitch before the deadline so it's ready if you qualify.

Recommended structure for your slides

#	Slide	What to show
1	Team	Team name, members and who owned what
2	Root cause	The biggest underlying problem in one sentence, and the symptoms it explains
3	Key findings	Your top three or four findings, ranked by impact, each with one line of evidence
4	Fixes and proof	What you changed and the test, query or before-and-after that proves it works
5	Live demo	A full and a partial refund end to end, with correct amounts in the dashboard and settlement report. Have screenshots ready in case the demo fails.
6	Under load	Your architecture, estimated vs measured capacity, and how your stack handles overload
7	How you used AI	Your setup in one line, and one time the AI was wrong and how you caught it
8	Decisions and open risks	What you chose not to change or run, why, and what is still open
	Appendix	Not presented. Make sure to add everything you want the judges to see in this section, such as queries, test output, diagrams and load test graphs.

4. Before you submit

Make sure that:

1. All of your code is in your own public fork, and that is the repository link you submit.
2. Both PDFs are named correctly, and the cover page has your live URLs, the link to your fork and your last commit ID.
3. Your server is up, your live links open, and it stays reachable until judging ends.

5. Worked on a local copy instead of a fork?

Don't worry, you can still move your work into your fork before 11 pm. Fork the challenge repository to your GitHub account first, then paste this prompt into your AI assistant and fill in the two links:

```
I worked on a coding challenge in a local copy of the challenge repository,
but my work needs to be in my own public fork on GitHub.

My fork: <PASTE YOUR FORK LINK>
The original challenge repository: <PASTE THE CHALLENGE REPO LINK>

Help me move all of my local work into my fork, step by step:
1. Check my setup first. Run git status, git remote -v and git log --oneline -5,
   and explain what you see. Don't change anything yet.
2. Make sure all of my changes are committed.
3. Point my local repository at my fork and push my work to it,
   keeping my commit history.
4. Confirm that my fork on GitHub shows my latest commit.

Rules: don't delete any files or local changes, never force push, and ask me
before running any command that changes something. If my folder isn't a git
repository, show me how to copy my files into a fresh clone of my fork instead.
```

Once it's done, open your fork on GitHub and check that your latest changes are there.

We wish you all the best!